

US COMMANDER Born 1914 Died 1974

Creighton W. Abrams

“The way to **eat** an **elephant** is **one bite at a time.**”

CREIGHTON ABRAMS, LETTER TO FRIENDS, 1964

On July 2, 1968, General Creighton W. Abrams replaced General William Westmoreland as commander of the Military Assistance Command Vietnam (MACV). This change had been anticipated for many weeks. Westmoreland's war of attrition, designed to force Hanoi to abandon the South, had failed and a new approach was needed. Abrams believed that the security of the South Vietnamese, right down to village level, was the key to success.